

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-07

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 20:1-8

1 It happened in the spring of the year, at the time kings go out to battle, that Joab led out the armed forces and ravaged the country of the people of Ammon, and came and besieged Rabbah. But David stayed at Jerusalem. And Joab defeated Rabbah and overthrew it.

2 Then David took their king's crown from his head, and found it to weigh a talent of gold, and there were precious stones in it. And it was set on David's head. Also he brought out the spoil of the city in great abundance.

3 And he brought out the people who were in it, and put them to work with saws, with iron picks, and with axes. So David did to all the cities of the people of Ammon. Then David and all the people returned to Jerusalem.

4 Now it happened afterward that war broke out at Gezer with the Philistines, at which time Sibbechai the Hushathite killed Sippai, who was one of the sons of the giant. And they were subdued.

5 Again there was war with the Philistines, and Elhanan the son of Jair killed Lahmi the brother of Goliath the Gittite, the shaft of whose spear was like a weaver's beam.

6 Yet again there was war at Gath, where there was a man of great stature, with twenty-four fingers and toes, six on each hand and six on each foot; and he also was born to the giant.

7 So when he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimea, David's brother, killed him.

8 These were born to the giant in Gath, and they fell by the hand of David and by the hand of his servants.

II. Key Summary

- At the time kings go out to battle, Joab led out the army, ravaged the country of Ammon, besieged Rabbah and overthrew it, while David stayed at Jerusalem (20:1).
 - David took the Ammonite king's gold crown, which weighed a talent and had precious stones in it, and it was set on his head; he also brought out much spoil and returned to Jerusalem with all the people (20:2-3).
 - Israel fought the Philistines three times: Sibbechai killed Sippai, Elhanan killed Lahmi, and Jonathan killed the man at Gath with twenty-four fingers and toes; all three fell by the hand of David and his servants (20:4-8).
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III. Passage Analysis

Easy days are the ones that need watching

"Beware of moments and hours of ease. It is in these that we most easily fall into the power of Satan... Watch and pray in days of vacation and ease, even more than at other times." [1]

About that stretch of time the text says only one thing: "But David stayed at Jerusalem" (20:1). At the time kings go out to battle, he stayed where it was comfortable — handing the fighting to Joab and resting in the city was already the problem.

Background: Chronicles skips what happened in Jerusalem during those months — while Joab was besieging Rabbah at the front, David took Bathsheba, the wife of his own soldier Uriah, and arranged for Uriah to be killed in battle (2 Samuel 11:2-12:25).

He was absent, and the victory still came

"Even though David had not yet repented, God still granted the victory; the covenant with David would never be changed by human failure." [2]

David stayed in the city, and Joab took Rabbah anyway; the crown was still set on David's head (20:1-2). David was not there, and Sibbechai, Elhanan and Jonathan still killed three sons of the giant (20:4-7). The victory God gave did not stall on David's absence.

IV. Reflection Question

Think of one thing you knew you should go do, and you stayed put instead — what were you doing that day?

At the time kings go out to battle, the text records only one line — "But David stayed at Jerusalem" (20:1) — and the stretch of time he stayed home was when he fell the hardest.

References

[1] Enduring Word (David Guzik), 1 Chronicles 20 (quoting F. B. Meyer),

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-20/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site, 1 Chronicles Comprehensive Commentary,

<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%20Chro/13GT20.htm>